



Based on the 31-Part Video Series by **Ustadh Hisham Abu Yusuf** (*Alfurqan Islamic Centre*)
Transforming the study of Divine Attributes into stories, Quranic parables, and spiritual journeys.

Episode	Arabic Name(s)	Transliteration	Primary Meaning	Core Storytelling Focus / Theme
Intro	الله	Allāh	The One True Deity	The Great Anchor of Human Longing & Divine Majesty
01	الرَّبِّ	Ar-Rabb	Master, Owner, Nurturer	The Silent Nurturing of a Seed into a Towering Tree
02	الْحَيِّ • الْقَيُّومُ	Al-Ḥayy, Al-Qayyūm	The Ever-Living, Self-Sustaining	The Unslumbering Pillar Holding Up the Cosmos
03	الرَّحْمَنُ • الرَّحِيمُ	Ar-Raḥmān, Ar-Raḥīm	The Most Gracious, Extremely Merciful	The Mother's Lost Child & Mercy Beyond Creation
04	الْعَفَّارُ • الْغَفُورُ • الْعَفُوُّ	Al-Ghaḥḥār, Al-Ghaḥfūr, Al-ʿAfuww	The Continual Forgiver, Pardoner	The Heavy Ledger Veiled and Wiped Clean as Fresh Snow
05	الْمَلِكُ • الْمَلِكُ • الْمَلِكُ	Al-Malik, Al-Mālik, Al-Malīk	The Sovereign King, True Owner	Fallen Crowns of Earthly Kings vs. The True Sovereign
06	الْعَلِيمُ • الْعَالِمُ • الْخَبِيرُ	Al-ʿAlīm, Al-ʿĀlim, Al-Khabīr	The All-Knowing, All-Aware	The Black Ant on a Dark Rock in the Pitch-Black Night
07	الْحَفِيطُ • الرَّقِيبُ • الْمُتَعَمِّدُ	Al-Ḥaḥḥīṭ, Ar-Raḥqīb, Al-Muḥaymin	The Preserver, All-Watchful	Young Ibrahim in the Fire & Musa's Basket on the Nile
08	الْقَادِرُ • الْقَدِيرُ • الْمُقْتَدِرُ	Al-Qādir, Al-Qadīr, Al-Muqtadīr	The Able, Omnipotent Master	The Parting of the Red Sea When Hope Was Exhausted
09	الْوَلِيُّ • الْمُؤَلَّى	Al-Walī, Al-Mawlā	Protecting Friend, Ally	The Lone Desert Traveler Who Finds He Is Never Alone
10	الْخَالِقُ • الْخَلَّاقُ • الْبَارِئُ • الْمُصَوِّرُ	Al-Khāliq, Al-Khallāq, Al-Bārī, Al-Muṣawwir	Creator, Originator, Fashioner	From Nothingness to the Marvel of Human Fingerprints
11	الْعَزِيزُ	Al-Ghaniyy	The Self-Sufficient, Independent	The Ocean That Never Drops Though All Creation Drinks
12	الْعَزِيزُ • الْحَكِيمُ	Al-ʿAzīz, Al-Ḥakīm	The All-Mighty, The All-Wise	Unyielding Power Guided by Gentle, Unseen Wisdom

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13	الرَّازِقُ • الرَّازِقُ	Ar-Razzāq, Ar-Rāziq	The Ultimate Provider	The Morning Bird Leaving Its Nest Empty-Bellied
14	اللطيف • الخبير	Al-Laṭīf, Al-Khabīr	The Subtle / Most Gentle, All-Aware	The Story of Yusuf: From Dark Well to Palace Throne
15	القوي • الممين	Al-Qawiyy, Al-Matīn	The All-Strong, The Firm	Tyrants Unravelled by the Smallest of Divine Soldiers
16	الحق	Al-Ḥaqq	The Real, Absolute Truth	The Unshakable Rock in a Sea of Fleeting Illusions
17	القريب • المجيب	Al-Qarīb, Al-Mujīb	The Ever-Near, The Responsive	The Whispering Heart in the Quietest Hour of the Night
18	الهادي	Al-Hādī	The Guide	A Single Beam of Light Awakening a Lost Pilgrim
19	الشكور • الشاكر • الحليم	Ash-Shakūr, Ash-Shākir, Al-Ḥalīm	Most Appreciative, The Forbearing	The Sinner Who Watered a Thirsty Dog & Was Forgiven
20	الوهاب • الفتاح	Al-Wahhāb, Al-Fattāḥ	Supreme Gift-Giver, The Opener	Zakariya's Prayer When Every Physical Door Was Barred
21	المنان	Al-Mannān	Bestower of Limitless Favor	Unasked Blessings Bestowed Before We Knew to Pray
22	القدوس • السلام	Al-Quddūs, As-Salām	Absolutely Pure, Source of Peace	Entering the Unblemished Sanctuary of Tranquility
23	الكريم • الأكرم • ذو الجلال والإكرام	Al-Karīm, Al-Akram, Dhūl-Jalāl	Most Generous, Lord of Majesty	The King Who Welcomes Returning Fugitives with Honor
24	الودود	Al-Wadūd	The Most Loving, Affectionate	Divine Love Courting Human Hearts Through Every Sunset
25	العظيم • الكبير • المتكبر	Al-'Aẓīm, Al-Kabīr, Al-Mutakabbir	The Supreme, Most Great	Human Arrogance Shattered Before Cosmic Grandeur
26	العلي • الأعلى • المتعال	Al-'Alīyy, Al-A'lā, Al-Muta'al	The High, Exalted Far Above	Forehead to Dust in Sujūd, Touching the Highest Exalted
27	الجبّار	Al-Jabbār	The Compeller, Mender of Hearts	Breaking Arrogant Kings while Mending Broken Souls
28	المؤمن	Al-Mu'min	Giver of Security & Faith	The Calm Mantle of Peaceful Trust Inside the Storm
29	الأول • الآخر • الظاهر • الباطن	Al-Awwal, Al-Ākhir, Az-Zāhir...	First, Last, Manifest, Hidden	The Unbroken Reality Encompassing All Time and Space
30	العملُ بِأَسْمَاءِ اللَّهِ الْحُسْنَى	Living with Allah's Names	Practical Application & Finale	Becoming a Living Reflection of Divine Light



Detailed Story-Driven Lesson Journeys

♦ Introduction | The Supreme Anchor of Human Longing

Arabic Notation

الله

Transliteration: *Allāh*

Primary Meaning: The Greatest Name; The One Sovereign Deity Worthy of All Devotion and Worship.

📖 The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham begins the entire playlist not with abstract definitions, but by painting a picture of the human heart searching for its home. Imagine a traveler wandering across a barren desert under scorching heat, drinking from shallow pools of saltwater that only leave him thirstier. Human desires, titles, riches, and relationships are like those saltwater pools—they lure us with temporary promises, yet leave a hollow ache inside.

Then, Ustadh Hisham brings us to the word **Allāh**. It is the proper, non-derived Supreme Name toward which every heart naturally gravitates (*Al-Ta'alluh*—to be captivated by love, awe, and surrender). Unlike other names that describe specific actions, *Allāh* is the majestic sun around which every attribute rotates. When a person cries out "*Yā Allāh!*" in the middle of terrifying darkness or overwhelmed joy, they are not invoking merely power or wisdom—they are calling upon the Absolute Essence that owns all beauty, all strength, and all refuge. Ustadh Hisham sets the stage: learning His names is not a test of intellectual memory; it is the recalibration of the soul back to its true Owner.

♦ Lesson 01 | The Silent Gardener of the Soul

Arabic Notation

الربّ

Transliteration: *Ar-Rabb*

Primary Meaning: The Lord, Owner, Master, Nurturer, and Constant Sustainer.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham invites us to reflect on a tiny, fragile seed buried beneath inches of heavy, cold, dark soil. Left alone, that seed seems helpless and forgotten. Yet, secretly beneath the surface, a hidden process begins. Water softens its shell, nutrients feed its core, a tender shoot breaks upward toward the sun, while deep roots anchor it into the earth. Years later, that tiny seed has transformed into a towering tree laden with sweet fruit, sheltering birds beneath its branches.

Who guided that silent transformation? That is **Ar-Rabb**. Ustadh Hisham explains that *Ar-Rabb* is not merely an Owner who stands at a distance. The word root implies *Tarbiyah*—nurturing something stage by stage, gently and continuously, until it reaches its highest perfection. Allah is *Rabb al-‘Ālamīn* (Lord of all worlds), caring for the universe physically by balancing planetary orbits, and spiritually by guiding you through life’s triumphs and painful heartbreaks. Every trial you encounter is not punishment; it is *Ar-Rabb* watering the hidden potential of your soul, pruning away toxic branches so you may grow into a spiritually mature believer.

◆ Lesson 02 | The Unslumbering Pillar of the Cosmos

Arabic Notation

الْحَيُّ • الْقَيُّومُ

Transliteration: *Al-Ḥayy, Al-Qayyūm*

Primary Meaning: The Ever-Living • The Self-Sustaining Maintainer of All Existence.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Imagine a bustling modern metropolis—trains roaring down tracks, hospital heart monitors beeping, millions of people working, sleeping, and breathing. Now imagine what happens if the power grid fails for even ten seconds: darkness descends, systems crash, and chaos erupts. Human existence is intensely fragile; we need food every few hours, sleep every night, and oxygen every second. Even the strongest leaders grow weary, age, and pass into dust.

Ustadh Hisham contrasts our fragile mortality with **Al-Ḥayy** and **Al-Qayyūm**. **Al-Ḥayy** possesses absolute, uncreated Life—free from beginning, end, sickness, or fatigue. **Al-Qayyūm** is the Self-Sustaining Bedrock who actively upholds every atom, galaxy, and beating heart in the cosmos. Ustadh Hisham reminds us of *Ayat al-Kursi*: “Neither drowsiness overcomes Him nor sleep.” While eight billion human beings close their eyes at night, exhausted and defenseless, *Al-Qayyūm* watches over every leaf falling from a tree and regulates every breath in your chest. When you lean on created things—money, status, or human allies—you are leaning on a leaning wall. But when you pray “*Yā Ḥayyu Yā Qayyūm, bi-rahmatika astagheeth*” (O Ever-Living, O Self-Sustaining, by Your mercy I seek relief), you anchor yourself to the unshakeable Pillar that never falls.

♦ Lesson 03 | The Mother's Lost Child & The Ocean of Mercy

Arabic Notation

الرَّحْمَنُ • الرَّحِيمُ

Transliteration: *Ar-Raḥmān, Ar-Raḥīm*

Primary Meaning: The Most Gracious (Vast Mercy) • The Extremely Merciful (Specific Mercy).

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham recounts a powerful narration from the life of the Prophet ﷺ after a battle. Among the captives was a frantic mother who had been separated from her infant baby. She ran frantically through the camp, tears streaming down her face, checking every child she saw. When she finally spotted her baby, she seized him, held him tightly against her chest, and began nursing him with unimaginable tenderness and relief. The Prophet ﷺ turned to his companions and asked: *"Do you think this mother could ever throw her baby into a burning fire?"* They replied, *"By Allah, no!"* The Prophet ﷺ then said: *"Allah is more merciful to His servants than this mother is to her child."*

Ustadh Hisham breaks down how this Divine Mercy manifests:

- **Ar-Raḥmān:** The vast, boundlessly overflowing mercy that covers *all* of creation—providing sunlight, air, food, and laughter to the believer and sinner alike.
- **Ar-Raḥīm:** The intimate, specialized mercy reserved specifically for believers—guiding their hearts toward faith, granting them tranquility during sorrow, and forgiving their mistakes. All the tenderness ever displayed on earth—from a mother bird feeding her chicks to human acts of compassion—is merely *one single part* of mercy that Allah sent down to Earth, keeping ninety-nine parts for the Day of Judgment.

♦ Lesson 04 | The Ledger Wiped Clean as Fresh Snow

Arabic Notation

الْغَفَّارُ • الْغَفُورُ • الْعَفُوُّ

Transliteration: *Al-Ghaffār, Al-Ghafūr, Al-‘Afuww*

Primary Meaning: The Continual Forgiver • The Supreme Pardoner • The One Who Erases Sins Entirely.

📖 The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham transports us to the scene of accounting on the Day of Resurrection. Picture a servant standing before his Creator, terrified as a massive book of deeds is opened. Page after page is stained with foolish choices, hidden sins, harsh words, and forgotten missteps. The servant hangs his head, convinced he is doomed.

Then, Ustadh Hisham unveils the delicate layers of Divine Forgiveness:

- **Al-Ghafūr / Al-Ghaffār:** Comes from *Mighfar* (the protective helmet worn by warriors). Allah covers the sin, veils it from the eyes of people in this world, and shields the servant from its punishment in the next. The sin remains recorded, but forgiven.
- **Al-‘Afuww:** Reaches an even profounder spiritual depth. ‘*Afw* literally means the wind blowing across footprints in the desert sand until every trace is erased. When Allah acts as *Al-‘Afuww*, He doesn't just cover the sin—He removes it from your book entirely, wipes it from the memory of the recording angels, and treats you as if you had never committed it. That is why Aisha (RA) was taught to supplicate in Laylat al-Qadr: "*Allāhumma innaka ‘Afuwwun tuḥibbul-‘afwa fa‘fu ‘annī*" (O Allah, You are the Eraser of Sins, You love to erase sins, so erase mine).

♦ Lesson 05 | The Fallen Crowns & The Eternal King

Arabic Notation

الْمَلِكُ • الْمَالِكُ • الْمَلِكُ

Transliteration: *Al-Malik, Al-Mālik, Al-Malik*

Primary Meaning: The Sovereign King • The Owner of All Dominion • The Absolute Monarch.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham paints a vivid historical landscape of earthly empires. Throughout history, mighty monarchs built marble palaces, raised massive armies, and demanded that subjects bow before them. Yet where are the Pharaohs, the Caesars, the Alexander the Greats today? Their thrones are buried in dust, their golden crowns rest in glass museum cases, and their bodies have rotted into soil. Earthly kingship is a temporary delusion; human rulers cannot even prevent their own hair from graying or their hearts from stopping.

Now imagine the grand scene depicted in the Quran on the Day when the universe is folded up like a scroll. The heavens are rolled in His Right Hand, human titles are stripped away, and a royal herald calls out into the silence: "*Li-manil-mulkul-yawm?*" (To whom belongs the dominion today?). No president, emperor, or billionaire dares answer. Then Allah Himself answers: "*Lillāhil-Wāḥidil-Qahhār*" (To Allah, the One, the Irresistible!). Ustadh Hisham teaches that understanding **Al-Malik** frees you from human fear. Why beg or bow before human bosses, rulers, or systems when you can stand directly before the King of kings in *Ṣalāh* five times a day?

♦ Lesson 06 | The Black Ant on the Dark Rock

Arabic Notation

الْعَلِيمُ • الْعَالِمُ • الْخَبِيرُ

Transliteration: *Al-‘Alīm, Al-‘Ālim, Al-Khabīr*

Primary Meaning: The All-Knowing • The Knower of Unseen Reality • The Deeply Aware.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham shares a classic spiritual metaphor passed down by early scholars: Imagine a tiny black ant crawling across a smooth black stone, at the bottom of a deep cave, in the middle of a pitch-black, moonless night. To human eyes, that ant is entirely invisible. To human ears, its footsteps make zero sound.

Yet, **Al-‘Alīm** and **Al-Khabīr** know the precise movement of every leg of that ant, the weight of its body against the rock, and even the subtle instinct driving it forward. Ustadh Hisham explains the distinction:

- **Al-‘Alīm:** Encompasses global, macro knowledge—every star in the galaxy, every drop of rain falling from the sky, every leaf dropping in a distant forest.
- **Al-Khabīr:** Penetrates the inner, micro realities—knowing not just *what* you did, but the subtle intentions, silent pains, hidden motives, and secret tears you wiped away when no one was looking. When you are misunderstood by the world, *Al-Khabīr* knows the true sincerity inside your chest.

♦ Lesson 07 | Musa's Basket & Young Ibrahim's Fire

Arabic Notation

الْحَفِيزُ • الرَّقِيبُ • الْمُهَيْمِنُ

Transliteration: *Al-Ḥafīẓ, Ar-Raqīb, Al-Muḥaymin*

Primary Meaning: The Preserver • The All-Watchful Guardian • The Supreme Overseer.

📖 The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham brings two iconic Quranic stories to life to illustrate divine preservation:

First, picture young Ibrahim (AS) thrown into a roaring cataclysmic fire by Namrud's soldiers. As he flew through the air toward the flames, Angel Jibril appeared and asked, "Do you need help?" Ibrahim replied, "From you, no. From Allah, yes." Allah did not extinguish the fire; instead, He commanded the flames: "Yā nāru kūnī bardan wa-salāman 'alā Ibrāhīm" (O fire, be cool and peaceful for Ibrahim!). The very element designed to destroy became a garden of safety because **Al-Ḥafīẓ** was preserving him.

Second, picture the mother of Musa (AS) holding her newborn infant while Pharaoh's soldiers searched house to house with drawn swords. Allah inspired her to place her baby inside a wooden basket and cast him into the rushing, treacherous River Nile! Human logic says that baby will drown or be eaten. But **Al-Muḥaymin** and **Ar-Raqīb** steered that fragile wooden box straight into the palace of Pharaoh himself, forcing Pharaoh to pay Musa's own mother to nurse him! Ustadh Hisham reminds us: when you protect Allah's commands in your youth, *Al-Ḥafīẓ* protects your mind, body, and loved ones in your old age.

♦ Lesson 08 | The Red Sea Splitting at the Edge of Despair

Arabic Notation

رُبُّ الْقَادِرِ • الْقَدِيرُ • الْمُقْتَدِرُ

Transliteration: *Al-Qādir, Al-Qadīr, Al-Muqtadir*

Primary Meaning: The Able • The All-Powerful Omnipotent Master • The Determinant of Destiny.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham takes us to the edge of the Red Sea. Prophet Musa (AS) and the Children of Israel are trapped. Ahead of them lies a roaring, impassable wall of ocean water. Behind them, dust clouds rise as Pharaoh's elite war chariots approach with weapons drawn. The followers panicked and screamed: *"Innaa la-mudrakūn!"* (We are surely overtaken! It's over!).

In human terms, they were 100% correct; math, physics, and strategy offered zero ways out. But Musa (AS) turned back with unshakeable conviction and said: *"Kallā! Inna ma'īya Rabbī sa-yahdīn"* (Never! Indeed, with me is my Lord; He will guide me through!). Musa struck the water with his staff, and **Al-Muqtadīr** commanded the ocean to split into twelve dry paths, walls of water standing like solid mountains on either side! Ustadh Hisham emphasizes that when you feel backed into a corner by debt, illness, or impossible circumstances, remember that *Al-Qadīr* does not work within the limits of human probability. He creates solutions out of absolute nothingness.

♦ Lesson 09 | The Lone Desert Traveler's Ultimate Ally

Arabic Notation

الْوَلِيُّ • الْمَوْلَى

Transliteration: *Al-Walī, Al-Mawlā*

Primary Meaning: The Protecting Friend • The Loving Guardian • The Supreme Patron & Ally.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Imagine walking through a dark, hostile territory full of bandits and hidden traps. You are small, weaponless, and terrified. But suddenly, the most powerful King in the realm steps beside you, places His hand upon your shoulder, and announces: *"This person is under my personal protection. Whoever touches him touches me."* Instantly, all fear vanishes; your posture straightens, and your heart fills with courage.

Ustadh Hisham explains that **Al-Walī** is precisely that divine Guardian for the believers. The Quran declares: *"Allāhu waliyyulladhīna āmanū yukhrijuhum minaz-ẓulumāti ilan-nūr"* (Allah is the Protecting Ally of those who believe; He brings them out of depth of darkness into light). Unlike human friends who abandon you when you lose your wealth, health, or status, *Al-Walī* never leaves your side. He defends your honor when people backbite you, orchestrates events in your favor, and pulls your heart out of depression back into spiritual light.

♦ Lesson 10 | From Mud to the Unique Fingerprint

Arabic Notation

الْخَالِقُ • الْخَلَّاقُ • الْبَارِيُّ • الْمُصَوِّرُ

Transliteration: *Al-Khāliq, Al-Khallāq, Al-Bāri', Al-Muṣawwir*

Primary Meaning: The Creator • The Perpetual Originator • The Evolver • The Fashioner of Forms.

📖 The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham breaks down the masterpiece of divine creation through a step-by-step artistic progression:

Imagine an architect designing a grand building:

1. **Al-Khāliq:** Conceives the original plan and measures out proportions before anything exists.
2. **Al-Bāri':** Executes the build, bringing the physical materials into existence from absolute non-existence, seamlessly without flaws.
3. **Al-Muṣawwir:** Gives each creation its unique, beautiful final appearance, colors, and features.

Ustadh Hisham asks us to look at our own hands. Out of the tens of billions of human beings who have walked the earth since Prophet Adam (AS), no two individuals have ever shared the exact same fingerprint, iris pattern, or voiceprint! *Al-Muṣawwir* sculpted you in your mother's womb, choosing your height, features, and identity with deliberate artistic love. You are not a random biological accident; you are a custom-designed creation of the Master Fashioner.

♦ Lesson 11 | The Ocean That Never Drops

Arabic Notation

الْغَنِيُّ

Transliteration: *Al-Ghaniyy*

Primary Meaning: The Self-Sufficient • The Absolutely Independent • The Rich Beyond Need.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham shares a breathtaking Hadith Qudsi that redefines our understanding of wealth: Allah says, *"O My servants! If the first of you and the last of you, the humans among you and the jinn among you, were to gather together in one single open plain and every single one of you asked Me for your greatest dream and desire, and I granted every single request—that would not decrease what I possess any more than a needle decreases the ocean when dipped into it!"*

Ustadh Hisham reflects on human poverty. Every human being is inherently poor (*Faqīr*)—needing air, water, sleep, acceptance, and guidance. Even billionaires are desperately poor, dependent on a tiny heart valve remaining unblocked. Only **Al-Ghaniyy** is completely independent of creation. He does not need our prayers, our fasting, or our worship; our worship does not add an atom to His kingdom, nor does our disobedience detract from it. When we pray, we are not doing Allah a favor—we are poor beggars coming to the doorstep of the Truly Rich.

♦ Lesson 12 | The Sword of Might Guided by Wisdom

Arabic Notation

الْعَزِيزُ • الْحَكِيمُ

Transliteration: *Al-‘Azīz, Al-Ḥakīm*

Primary Meaning: The All-Mighty / Invincible • The All-Wise.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham explores why **Al-‘Azīz** (The All-Mighty) and **Al-Ḥakīm** (The All-Wise) are paired together so frequently in the Quran.

In human society, when a ruler gains immense power (*‘Azzah*), he almost inevitably turns into a ruthless tyrant, abusing his authority because there is no one to check him. On the flip side, someone with great wisdom might lack the strength to enforce justice. Human power without wisdom is tyranny; wisdom without power is helplessness.

In Allah, these two attributes harmonize perfectly. **Al-‘Azīz** possesses invincible, unbeatable power that no army or rebel can ever overcome. Yet that absolute power is governed 100% of the time by **Al-Ḥakīm**—perfect, flawless wisdom. Every law He ordains, every hardship He permits, and every door He closes is executed with ultimate purpose. Ustadh Hisham references the journey of Musa and Al-Khidr: a boat was damaged, a child was lost, and a wall was rebuilt—events that seemed painful or confusing on the surface, but were driven by profound, unseen wisdom behind the veil.

♦ Lesson 13 | The Morning Bird & Unseen Provision

Arabic Notation

الرَّزَاقُ • الرَّازِقُ

Transliteration: *Ar-Razzāq, Ar-Rāziq*

Primary Meaning: The Ultimate Provider • The Continuous Sustainer of All Creation.

📖 The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham cites the famous Hadith of the Prophet ﷺ: *"If you were to rely upon Allah with true reliance, He would provide for you just as He provides for the birds: they wake up in the morning with empty bellies and return in the evening full and satisfied."*

Picture a little bird sitting in its nest at dawn. It has no refrigerator, no bank account, no farmland, and no stock portfolio. It doesn't sit idly in its nest waiting for worms to fall from the sky; it spreads its wings and flies out into the vast world. And **Ar-Razzāq** has placed a worm under a specific leaf, a berry on a specific branch, and fresh water in a specific stream waiting for it.

Ustadh Hisham distinguishes between two types of *Rizq* (Provision):

1. **Material Provision:** Food, money, health, and shelter given to all creatures.
2. **Spiritual Provision:** Beneficial knowledge, deep faith, righteous companionship, and peace of heart—the higher provision granted to those whom He loves. Never stress over your provision; what was written for you will find you even if you hide beneath a mountain.

♦ Lesson 14 | Yusuf's Journey: From Well to Throne

Arabic Notation

اللَّطِيفُ • الْخَبِيرُ

Transliteration: *Al-Laṭīf, Al-Khabīr*

Primary Meaning: The Subtle / Most Gentle • The All-Aware of Intricate Secrets.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham narrates the master narrative of Surah Yusuf to explain the beauty of **Al-Laṭīf**—The One who delivers blessings through mechanisms so subtle, gentle, and hidden that you don't even realize it is happening until the final moment.

Look at the life of young Yusuf (AS):

1. His jealous brothers throw him into a dark, abandoned well to be forgotten.
2. A passing caravan pulls him out and sells him into slavery in Egypt.
3. He is falsely accused of a crime and locked in a dark prison for years.

To any onlooker, Yusuf's life was a series of tragic disasters. But behind the scenes, **Al-Laṭīf** was subtly arranging every piece! The well brought him to Egypt; the slavery brought him into the minister's household; the prison brought him to meet the king's cupbearer, which led to interpreting the King's dream, which ultimately placed Yusuf on the throne as Treasurer of Egypt! At the very end of the story, Prophet Yusuf smiles and declares: *"Inna Rabbī Laṭīfun limā yashā"* (Indeed, my Lord is Subtle to whom He wills!). Ustadh Hisham reassures us: the very disappointment breaking your heart today may be the gentle, subtle mechanism *Al-Laṭīf* is using to elevate you tomorrow.

◆ Lesson 15 | The Smallest Army That Destroyed Tyrants

Arabic Notation

القَوِيُّ • الْمَتِينُ

Transliteration: *Al-Qawiyy, Al-Matīn*

Primary Meaning: The Possessor of All Strength • The Firm, Unyielding Power.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham reflects on human arrogance throughout history. Men like Namrud, Pharaoh, and the people of 'Ād built giant monuments and flexed their military muscle, asking insolently: *"Who is stronger than us in power?"*

Ustadh Hisham shows how **Al-Qawiyy** and **Al-Matīn** humbled them—not with giant cosmic weapons, but with the smallest, seemingly weakest creatures:

- Namrud, who claimed to control life and death, was brought down by a single tiny mosquito that entered his nostril, driving him insane until he died.
- The people of Abraha marched toward Mecca with massive war elephants to destroy the Ka'bah. Allah sent flocks of small birds (*Abābīl*) carrying tiny clay stones that flattened their army like chewed straw!

Human strength is fragile and exhausting. But **Al-Matin** possesses power that never diminishes, never tires, and never requires effort. When you feel weak, oppressed, or exhausted by life's struggles, remember that the Almighty Ally behind you holds all power in His hands.

◆ Lesson 16 | The Anchor in a Sea of Illusions

Arabic Notation

الْحَقُّ

Transliteration: *Al-Ḥaqq*
Primary Meaning: The Ultimate Truth • The Absolute, Unchanging Reality.

📖 The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham paints a picture of our modern, fast-paced world—a world filled with fake news, changing social trends, fleeting beauty, virtual illusions, and promises that fade like smoke. People anchor their self-worth on social media likes, bank balances, or human approval, only to feel crushed when those illusions inevitably collapse.

Then comes the divine name **Al-Ḥaqq**. Allah is the Absolute, Unchangeable Reality. His existence is Truth; His Word is Truth; His Promise is Truth; the Meeting with Him is Truth; Paradise is Truth; and Hellfire is Truth. When you build your life around earthly illusions, you are building on shifting sand dunes. But when you align your lifestyle, income, and morals with *Al-Ḥaqq*, you root your soul into eternal bedrock that no cultural storm can ever tear down.

◆ Lesson 17 | The Whispering Heart in the Quiet Hour

Arabic Notation

الْقَرِيبُ • الْمُجِيبُ

Transliteration: *Al-Qarīb, Al-Mujīb*
Primary Meaning: The Ever-Near • The One Who Answers Supplications.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham shares a touching scene from the Seerah: A Bedouin came to the Prophet ﷺ and asked: "O Messenger of Allah, is our Lord near so we may whisper to Him, or is He far so we must shout to Him?" The Prophet ﷺ remained silent until Allah revealed directly from above the seven heavens: "Wa-idhā sa'alaka 'ibādī 'annī fa-innī QARĪB, ujibu da'wata-dā'i idhā da'ān" (And when My servants ask you concerning Me—indeed, I am NEAR. I respond to the call of the caller when he calls upon Me).

Ustadh Hisham points out a miraculous literary detail in the Quran: Whenever the Sahabah asked the Prophet ﷺ about orphans, mountains, or charity, Allah instructed him: "Say (Qul) to them..." But when they asked if Allah was near, Allah dropped the word "Say"! There is no intermediary, no secretary, no priest, and no gatekeeper between you and Allah. When you raise your hands in the third part of the night, while the rest of the world is fast asleep, **Al-Qarīb** is closer to you than your own jugular vein, listening to the silent tears you cannot put into words.

♦ Lesson 18 | The Lighthouse in Spiritual Darkness

Arabic Notation

الْهَادِي

Transliteration: *Al-Hādī*

Primary Meaning: The Ultimate Guide • The One Who Directs Hearts to Righteousness.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Imagine driving down a winding mountain road in the middle of a torrential rainstorm at midnight. The fog is thick, your GPS signal is lost, and sheer cliffs plummet on either side. You are terrified that one wrong turn will send you crashing to your demise. Suddenly, a bright, clear beam from a lighthouse pierces through the darkness, illuminating the safe road home.

That lighthouse is the guidance of **Al-Hādī**. Ustadh Hisham explains that human intelligence, books, and degrees can give you information, but only *Al-Hādī* can grant true spiritual *Hidāyah* (Guidance) into the heart. That is why we repeat in every single unit of prayer: "*Idhinaṣ-ṣirāṭal-mustaqīm*" (Guide us to the Straight Path). Guidance is not a one-time event; it is a continuous stream of divine light you need every single day to navigate worldly temptations and keep your feet firm upon the truth.

♦ Lesson 19 | The Thirsty Dog & The Multiplied Reward

Arabic Notation

الشَّكُورُ • الشَّاكِرُ • الْحَلِيمُ

Transliteration: *Ash-Shakūr, Ash-Shākir, Al-Ḥalīm*

Primary Meaning: The Most Appreciative • The Forbearing, Slow to Punish.

📖 The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham recounts the beautiful story told by the Prophet ﷺ about a man walking down a road on a scorching day. The man was dying of thirst, found a deep well, climbed down, drank his fill, and climbed back up. At the top, he saw a dog panting heavily, licking moist mud out of extreme thirst. The man thought to himself: *"This creature is suffering from thirst just as I was."* He climbed back down into the well, filled his leather shoe with water, held it between his teeth, climbed out, and gave water to the dog until its thirst was quenched.

Allah looked upon that simple act, appreciated it (**Fashakara lah**), and forgave all of that man's lifetime of sins!

Ustadh Hisham highlights the mind-blowing generosity of **Ash-Shakūr**: Human appreciation is small; when someone helps us, we say thank you. But when Allah acts as *Ash-Shakūr*, He takes your small, imperfect deed—a smile to a stranger, a single dollar given in charity, a moment of controlling your anger—and multiplies its reward tenfold, seven hundred-fold, and beyond, rewarding a temporary life of worship with eternal Paradise!

♦ Lesson 20 | Unlocking the Bolted Doors

Arabic Notation

الْوَهَّابُ • الْفَتَّاحُ

Transliteration: *Al-Wahhāb, Al-Fattāḥ*

Primary Meaning: The Supreme Gift-Giver • The Opener of Closed Doors & Keys of Mercy.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham brings us to the story of Prophet Zakariya (AS). He was an old man with thinning white hair, a frail body, and a wife who had been barren her entire life. Biologically and medically, having a child was 100% impossible. Yet Zakariya stood in prayer and called upon **Al-Wahhāb** (The Unconditional Gift-Giver who gives without expecting anything in return).

Instantly, angels called out to him while he was standing in prayer: "*Allah gives you good news of Yahya!*"

Ustadh Hisham pairs this with **Al-Fattāḥ**—The Master Opener. Imagine standing before a massive steel door locked with ten heavy padlocks. You have tried every human key, bumped your shoulders against it, and cried in frustration, but the door won't budge. When you invoke *Yā Fattāḥ*, He doesn't just unlock the door; He removes the entire wall! He opens closed hearts, opens doors of financial provision, opens pathways out of depression, and grants victories when all hope seems lost.

♦ Lesson 21 | The Gifts Before We Even Knew to Ask

Arabic Notation

الْمَنَّانُ

Transliteration: *Al-Mannān*

Primary Meaning: The Bestower of Limitless Favor • The Initiator of Unasked Blessings.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham asks us to pause and do a mental inventory of our lives. Before you were born, when you were floating in your mother's womb as a microscopic cell, did you ask Allah for oxygen? Did you pray for a mother to love you, a beating heart, eyes that see colors, or a brain that processes thought? You didn't ask for any of it—you couldn't even speak!

That is the essence of **Al-Mannān**. Human generosity is almost always reactive—someone asks us for help, and we respond. But *Al-Mannān* initiates immense blessings *before* you even know you need them! He provided the atmosphere before He created lungs; He provided mother's milk before He brought the baby into the world; and He sent down Islam and the Quran before you were ever born. Recognizing *Al-Mannān* fills the heart with overwhelming gratitude, realizing that our very existence is floating upon an ocean of unearned divine favors.

♦ Lesson 22 | The Flawless Sanctuary of Peace

Arabic Notation

الْقُدُّوسُ • السَّلَامُ

Transliteration: *Al-Quddūs, As-Salām*

Primary Meaning: The Absolutely Pure & Holy • The Source and Giver of Peace.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham invites us to visualize entering a pristine mountain sanctuary. Outside, war, noise, pollution, betrayal, and chaos rage. But the moment you step inside this sanctuary, total silence descends. The air is crystal pure, free from dust; there is no anxiety, no threat, and no defect.

Allah is **Al-Quddūs**—transcendentally pure, exalted far above any flaw, weakness, partner, or human limitation. He has no fatigue, no error, and no injustice.

Because He is *Al-Quddūs*, He is also **As-Salām**—The Source of all Peace. The human soul is constantly battered by worldly anxieties, fears of the future, and grief over the past. True peace (*Sakīnah*) cannot be bought in a pharmacy or found in material wealth. When you turn your heart toward *As-Salām*, He pours tranquility directly into your chest, granting you an inner calm that remains untouched even while the world crumbles around you.

♦ Lesson 23 | The King Who Honors Returning Fugitives

Arabic Notation

الْكَرِيمُ • الْأَكْرَمُ • ذُو الْجَلَالِ وَالْإِكْرَامِ

Transliteration: *Al-Karīm, Al-Akram, Dhūl-Jalāli wal-Ikrām*

Primary Meaning: The Most Generous • The Most Bountiful • Lord of Majesty and Honor.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham tells a story of a servant who committed treason against his King. He stole from the royal treasury, broke the King's laws, and fled into hiding. Years later, impoverished, broken, and filled with guilt, the fugitive servant decided to return, creeping back to the palace gates expecting execution or lifetime imprisonment.

When the King saw him, instead of ordering his execution, he embraced him, covered him in royal garments, washed away his grime, gave him a place at his personal dinner table, and elevated his status before all the court!

That is **Al-Karīm** and **Al-Akram**. Ustadh Hisham explains that human generosity gives when deserving. But Allah's *Karam* (Generosity) is so boundless that when a rebellious sinner turns back in sincere repentance (*Tawbah*), Allah doesn't just forgive the sins—He transforms those past bad deeds into shiny good deeds (*Yubaddilullāhu sayyi'ātihim ḥasanāt*)! He honors the returning servant and elevates their status in His sight.

♦ Lesson 24 | Divine Love Courting Human Hearts

Arabic Notation

الْوَدُودُ

Transliteration: *Al-Wadūd*

Primary Meaning: The Most Loving • The Affectionate • The One Who Woos Creation with Love.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham highlights a profound linguistic distinction in Arabic:

- *Hubb*: Internal feeling of love inside the heart.
- *Wudd*: Active, tangible expression of love—a warm gift, a smile, a kind gesture.

Allah is not just *Muḥibb* (One who loves); He is **Al-Wadūd**—The One who actively expresses His affection to His servants every single day! Look around you: the breathtaking pink sunset after a long day, the soothing sound of rain, the sweet taste of fruit, the comfort of a good friend, and the peaceful feeling during prayer are all personal love notes sent from *Al-Wadūd* to court your heart back to Him.

Ustadh Hisham reflects: Human beings love you for what *they* can get out of you—your companionship, your money, or your status. But *Al-Wadūd* loves you for *your* benefit, desiring only that you attain eternal success and joy in His presence.

♦ Lesson 25 | Standing Before cosmic Grandeur

Arabic Notation

الْعَظِيمُ • الْكَبِيرُ • الْمُتَكَبِّرُ

Transliteration: *Al-‘Aẓīm, Al-Kabīr, Al-Mutakabbir*

Primary Meaning: The Supreme • The Most Great • The Proudly Majestic.

📖 The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham takes us on a mental journey into deep space. Imagine floating past the moon, looking back at planet Earth—a tiny, fragile blue marble suspended in void darkness. Fly further out past the solar system, past the Milky Way galaxy containing 100 billion stars, past billions of other galaxies stretching across light-years. Entire human civilizations, empires, and history took place on a microscopic speck of cosmic dust!

How absurd, then, is human pride? When a man struts across the earth boasting of his wealth, luxury car, or physical strength, he is like an ant boasting to a mountain!

Ustadh Hisham explains that **Al-‘Aẓīm** and **Al-Kabīr** own true, unapproachable Greatness. **Al-Mutakabbir** is a title that belongs *exclusively* to Allah; when humans act arrogant, it is a disgusting disease because they are wearing a cloak that doesn't belong to them. But when Allah claims *Al-Mutakabbir*, it is absolute truth, shattering all human pretenders and forcing arrogant tyrants to their knees.

♦ Lesson 26 | Sujūd: The Lowest Point Touching the Highest

Arabic Notation

الْعَلِيُّ • الْأَعْلَى • الْمُتَعَالَى

Transliteration: *Al-‘Aliyy, Al-A‘lā, Al-Muta‘āl*

Primary Meaning: The High • The Most High • The Exalted Far Above Creation.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham reflects on the physical body position of *Sujūd* (Prostration). In human culture, placing your nose and forehead onto the bare dirt is the ultimate sign of humiliation, defeat, and surrender. You drop lower than everything else in the room.

Yet, in Islamic worship, the Prophet ﷺ declared: *"The closest a servant ever comes to his Lord is while he is in Sujūd."*

Why this beautiful paradox? Because when you willingly drop your ego, your status, and your forehead to the lowest dirt for the sake of **Al-A'la** (The Most High), your soul transcends the physical universe! You whisper at the ground: *"Subhāna Rabbiyal-A'la"* (Glory be to my Lord, the Most High), and that humble whisper travels beyond the clouds, beyond the solar system, past the seven heavens, directly to the Throne of the Exalted Lord!

♦ Lesson 27 | The Mender of Broken Souls

Arabic Notation

الْجَبَّارُ

Transliteration: *Al-Jabbār*

Primary Meaning: The Compeller • The Restorer • The Mender of Broken Hearts.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham unravels a common misunderstanding around the name **Al-Jabbār**. In political terms, people associate *Jabbār* with a ruthless tyrant who compels people by force. But in classical Arabic, *Jabara* originally comes from *Jabeerah*—the wooden splint used by a compassionate doctor to set and mend a shattered, broken bone so it can heal whole again!

Al-Jabbār possesses a beautiful dual nature:

1. Toward arrogant tyrants and oppressors: He compels them, breaks their pride, and enforces His divine decree over their plans.
2. Toward the broken-hearted, the grieving, and the oppressed: He is the tender Mender! When your heart is shattered into a thousand sharp pieces by betrayal, bereavement, or failure, no human words can fix you. But when you come to *Al-Jabbār* in prayer, He gently piecing your broken spirit back together, filling the cracks with faith, light, and renewed strength.

♦ Lesson 28 | The Quiet Mantle of Trust in the Storm

Arabic Notation

الْمُؤْمِنُ

Transliteration: *Al-Mu'min*

Primary Meaning: The Giver of Security • The Granter of Faith • The Confirmer of Truth.

📖 The Story & Teaching Journey

Imagine a nightmarish sea storm: giant dark waves crashing over a wooden ship, lightning tearing through black clouds, sailors screaming in terror as water fills the deck. In the middle of this total panic, one passenger sits calmly in the corner, holding his child, eyes serene, breathing slowly, completely devoid of fear.

Where does that supernatural calmness come from? It comes from **Al-Mu'min**.

Ustadh Hisham explains that *Al-Mu'min* is the divine source of *Amn* (Absolute Security). In a terrifying world filled with illness, economic instability, war, and sudden death, human hearts naturally tremble. But when *Al-Mu'min* casts His divine mantle of security (*Sakīnah*) into your heart, you realize that nothing can touch you except what He has written for your ultimate good. He fulfills every promise He made to His servants, securing believers from injustice in this world and guaranteeing them safety from the terror of the Day of Judgment.

♦ Lesson 29 | The Eternal Anchor Beyond Time and Space

Arabic Notation

• الْأَوَّلُ • الْآخِرُ • الظَّاهِرُ • الْبَاطِنُ • الْأَحَدُ الصَّمَدُ

Transliteration: *Al-Awwal, Al-Ākhir, Aẓ-Zāhir, Al-Bāṭin, Al-Aḥad, Aṣ-Ṣamad*

Primary Meaning: The First, The Last, The Manifest, The Hidden • The One & Only • The Eternal Refuge.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham synthesizes these master names into a single, breathtaking cosmic equation taught by the Prophet ﷺ in his evening supplications:

"O Allah, You are Al-Awwal (The First), there was nothing before You. You are Al-Ākhir (The Last), there will be nothing after You. You are Aẓ-Ẓāhir (The Manifest), there is nothing above You. You are Al-Bāṭin (The Hidden), there is nothing closer than You!"

Think about time and space:

- Roll back time past your birth, past ancient history, past the Big Bang—before time itself existed, **Al-Awwal** was there.
- Fast-forward time past your death, past the destruction of Earth, past the end of the universe—when everything decays into dust, **Al-Ākhir** remains eternal.
- Look at creation: His power is **Aẓ-Ẓāhir** (Manifest) in every mountain and sunset, yet His Essence is **Al-Bāṭin** (Hidden) from mortal eyes.

He is **Aṣ-Ṣamad**—the indestructible, solid Master to whom every atom in creation turns in utter desperation, while He needs no one. Anchoring your soul to these names frees you from time-bound anxieties forever.

◆ Lesson 30 (Finale) | Living as a Reflection of Divine Light

Arabic Notation

الْعَمَلُ بِأَسْمَاءِ اللَّهِ الْحُسْنَى

Transliteration: *Living with Allah's Names*

Primary Meaning: Transforming Knowledge into Character, Action, and Devotion.

The Story & Teaching Journey

Ustadh Hisham closes the 31-part series with a passionate, heart-moving finale. He stands before the audience and asks: *"Now that we have spent 30 lessons learning the beauty, grandeur, and secrets of Allah's Names—what comes next?"*

Learning Allah's Names is not an academic exercise to pass an exam or impress people in debate. The Prophet ﷺ said: *"Indeed, Allah has ninety-nine names; whoever Aḥṣāhā (enumerates, understands, and lives by them) will enter Paradise."*

Aḥṣāhā means three progressive levels:

1. **Memorization & Meaning:** Knowing the words and their definitions.

2. **Du‘ā’ & Supplication:** Calling upon Allah by His specific names depending on your situation (*Yā Razzāq* when needing provision, *Yā Shāfi* when sick, *Yā Ghafūr* when sinning).

3. **Character Transformation (*Al-Takhallaq*):** Letting these names reshape your daily human behavior!

- Because He is **Al-Karīm** (Generous), you become generous to your neighbors.
- Because He is **Al-Ghafūr** (Forgiving), you forgive those who hurt you.
- Because He is **Al-Laṭīf** (Gentle), you speak gently to your parents and children.
- Because He is **Ar-Raqīb** (Watchful), you guard your tongue and eyes when alone in the dark.

Ustadh Hisham leaves us with a final spiritual image: Your heart is a mirror. When you clean away the rust of heedlessness and polish it with the deep understanding of *Asmā’ Allāh al-Ḥusnā*, your heart begins to reflect the light of Divine Beauty into a dark world, transforming you into a beacon of mercy, wisdom, and peace.
